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SUPERSEDING
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19 February 1952

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLEANING COMPOUND, ALKALI TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one class of alkaline cleaning compound suitable for use in the hot soak tank cleaning of ferrous and nonferrous alloy parts.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

O–S–604—Sodium Metasilicate.
O–T–671—Trisodium-Phosphate, Technical (Phosphate Cleaner).
P–S–536—Soap and Soap-Products (Including Synthetic Detergents); Methods of Sampling and Testing.
QQ–A–561—Aluminum Alloy 2S; Plate and Sheet.
SS–A–706—Asphalt; (for use in) Road and Pavement Constructions.
VV–L–791—Lubricants, Liquid Fuels, and Related Products; Methods of Inspection, Sampling, and Testing.
PPP–P–31—Preservation, Packaging, Packing, and Marking of Material; and Shipping Instructions (Domestic Shipment and Storage).

Military Specification:

MIL–L–15016—Lubricating Oil; General Purpose.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL–STD–129—Marking of Shipments.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under "General Information" in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the GSA Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Specifications and standard applicable only to individual departments are listed in section 7.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Qualification (type or brand approval).**—Unless otherwise specified, clean-

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ing compound, alkali-type purchased under this specification shall be of brand or type which has been tested and found to meet all the requirements of section 3 of this specification. (See 6.4).

3.2 Materials.—The raw materials used in manufacture of these compounds shall be of high quality, intimately assembled and processed so as to produce a granular product which will remain uniform in composition and show no evidence of segregation or caking during handling or storage. (See 3.10). The compound when used as a hot soak cleaner at boiling temperature and a concentration of 7.5 percent (7.5 grams of compound in 100 ml. of solution) shall effectively remove asphalt, mineral oil, grease and road dirt from metal parts. Nonferrous metals shall not be attacked under these conditions.

3.3 Composition.—The cleaning compound is not required to conform to definite chemical composition requirements. The manufacturer is given wide latitude in the selection of raw material and processes of manufacture, provided that the product meets all applicable requirements of this specification. The compound shall not contain any toxic or volatile substances, such as chlorinated hydrocarbons, phenolic compounds, benzene, or the like.

3.4 Performance requirements. — The cleaning compound, alkali-type, shall be equal or superior in effectiveness to the comparison formula in 4.4.1.3 in all respects when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The compound covered by this specification shall be tested simultaneously with the comparison alkali-type cleaning compound specified in 4.4.1.3.

3.4.1 *Cleaning efficiency.* — The cleaning compound covered by this specification shall be equal or superior to the standard comparison cleaning compound specified in 4.4.1.3, prepared and tested under the same conditions, in ability to remove mineral oil and asphalt soils from metal surfaces when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.4.2 *Stability.*—The compound covered by this specification, when boiled for 40 hours and tested as specified in 4.4.1.2, shall be equal or superior to the standard comparison formula, prepared and tested under the same conditions, in ability to remove soils from metal surfaces.

3.5 Corrosiveness. — The cleaning compound, alkali-type, shall not attack aluminum. When tested in accordance with 4.4.2, there shall be no loss in weight of aluminum test panels conforming to Federal Specification QQ–A–561, nor shall there be any visible staining, discoloration, etching or pitting of the test specimens.

3.6 pH value.—The pH value of a distilled water solution of the compound at a concentration of 7.5 percent (7.5 grams of compound in 100 ml. of solution) shall be not more than 12.1 when tested at 25° C., as specified in 4.4.3.

3.7 Dust forming properties. — When tested as specified in 4.4.4, the dust forming properties shall be such that the dust shall settle within a period of five seconds.

3.8 Surface tension.—The surface tension of a 0.05 percent solution (0.05 grams of compound in 100 ml. of solution) of the compound in distilled water at 25° C. shall be not more than 36 dynes per centimeter when determined as specified in 4.4.5.

3.9 Penetration.—When tested as specified in 4.4.6, the average penetration shall be not less than 30.0.

3.10 Segregation.—When tested as specified in 4.4.7, the difference of the percentages of any ingredient of the compound (such as silicates, carbonates, or total phosphates) taken from different portions of a container shall not exceed 2 percent of the average percentage of that ingredient in the com-

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pound. (The compound shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.4.7 at the discretion of the inspection laboratory when segregation of the ingredients appears to have occurred.)

3.11 **Workmanship.**—The compound shall be manufactured in accordance with the best commercial practice to produce a high quality material which is stable and not subject to change during storage in a sealed container.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.

4.1.1 *Lot.*—For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all material mixed or prepared at one time in one vessel. Material shall be identified by order of production or batch number.

4.1.2 *Sampling for inspection of filled containers.*—A random sample of filled containers shall be taken from each lot by the Government inspector in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105 at Inspection Level I and Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) = 2.5 percent defective to verify compliance with all stipulations of this specification regarding fill, closure, marking, and other requirements not involving tests.

4.1.3 *Sampling for tests.*—A minimum of two samples, each weighing approximately one pound, shall be taken from each lot.

4.2 **Inspection.**—Inspection shall be at the point of delivery, unless otherwise specified.

4.3 **Tests.**—Testing under this specification shall be for the purpose of:

(a) Qualification.
(b) Acceptance of individual lots.

4.3.1 *Qualification tests.* — Qualification tests shall consist of tests for all the requirements of this specification. Qualification tests shall be conducted at the Paint and Chemical Laboratory, Aberdeen Proving Ground, Maryland. (See 6.4.)

4.3.2 *Acceptance tests.* — Inspection tests for acceptance of individual lots shall be made at a Government laboratory and shall normally consist of tests for all requirements specified in section 3 with the exception of the cleaning efficiency and stability tests for mineral oil. (The cleaning efficiency and stability tests for inspection purposes shall normally consist of tests on asphalt soil only.) The procuring agency, however, reserves the right to make the tests for compliance to all the requirements specified above.

4.4 Test methods.

4.4.1 *Performance tests.* — Performance tests shall consist of:

(a) Cleaning efficiency.
(b) Stability.

4.4.1.1 *Cleaning efficiency test.*

4.4.1.1.1 *Preparation of test panels.*—Test panels of WD–1020, 18–20 gage, cold-rolled steel, 2½ by 2½ inches in size, with a ¼-inch diameter hole placed ⅛ inch from one corner, shall be prepared. Sharp edges shall be smoothed with No. 1 emery cloth. The panels shall then be degreased in c.p. grade acetone. Polish both faces with No. 1 emery cloth stroking in one direction only. Clean in a hot alkaline solution until free from water break. Rinse in water, then dip in absolute ethyl alcohol, and wipe dry with paper toweling.

4.4.1.1.2 *Application of soils.*—The following soils shall be applied to separate panels:

4.4.1.1.2.1 *Mineral oil.* — The soiling material shall be Military Symbol Oil 3065 conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–15016. The cleaned panels shall be suspended

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on an "S" hook and dipped into a 400-ml. beaker of the oil at a temperature of 25° ± 1° C. They then shall be removed and allowed to drain at a temperature of 26° ± 1° C. for 30 minutes. The remaining drop of oil in the lower corner of each panel is then removed with absorbent cotton. The amount of mineral oil adhering per panel shall be approximately 0.16 gram.

4.4.1.1.2.2 *Asphalt.*—The soiling material shall be petroleum asphalt conforming to Federal Specification SS–A–706, grade 85–100, designation AP–3. The soil, heated to approximately 50° C., shall be spread evenly over one face of the cleaned test panels using the edge of a steel spatula, leaving unsoiled the triangular area at the corner which includes the ¼-inch hole. The amount of asphalt on each panel shall be 0.32–0.34 gm., determined by trial and error. Allow each panel to stand for 15 minutes before stripping.

4.4.1.1.3 *Preparation of cleaning solutions.*—In a 2-liter beaker, prepare 1600 ml. of a 7.5 percent (weight of compound in 100 ml. of solution), distilled water solution of the test compound. A similarly prepared solution shall be made of the standard comparison compound. Bring solutions to a boil and keep at this temperature throughout the test. Maintain solution level throughout the test by addition of distilled water.

4.4.1.1.4 *Cleaning procedure.*—Three test panels for each type of soil, prepared as specified in 4.4.1.1.2, shall be cleaned successively as specified hereinafter in the following order: mineral oil, then asphalt. The soiled test panel shall be immersed in the cleaning solution specified in 4.4.1.1.3 by means of an iron hook, one end of which passes through the ¼-inch hole and the other end over a glass rod placed across the top of the 2-liter beaker. At the end of 3-minute intervals the test panel shall be moved forward and backward, six times in each direction, and then up and down three times in each direction. This agitation of the panels is applied in the cleaning of the asphalt test panels but not in the cleaning of the mineral oil panels. The panel shall then be removed from the solution for visual inspection of the extent of soil removal and quickly replaced. The entire operation of agitation of the test panel and visual inspection shall require not more than 6 seconds. Mineral oil test panels shall be cleaned for 3 minutes, and asphalt-soiled panels for 21 minutes respectively. At the end of the specified cleaning period, or before, if visual inspection indicates completeness of soil removal, the panel shall be removed from the cleaning solution and given two 6-second rinses in distilled water (no agitation); there shall be a 4-second drain between rinses. The rinsing solutions shall consist of 2 one-liter beakers, one containing 800 ml. of distilled water at 23° ± 3° C.

4.4.1.1.5 *Measurement of residual soil.*

4.4.1.1.5.1 *Asphalt.* — Rinsed asphalt test panels, after treatment specified in 4.4.1.1.4, shall be dried for 15 minutes in an oven at a temperature of 75° ± 1° C., followed by cooling at room temperature for 30 minutes. They shall then be examined for number and size of residual spots of soil, and weighed to the nearest 0.0001 gm. The residual asphalt shall be scrubbed off with benzene or xylene, using paper toweling, after which the panel is rinsed in absolute ethyl alcohol, dried with paper toweling, and reweighed. The difference in weight is the amount of residual soil. Tests shall be run in triplicate.

4.4.1.1.5.2 *Mineral oil.*—Rinsed mineral oil test panels, after treatment as specified in 4.4.1.1.4, shall be examined for presence or absence of waterbreak. They shall then be dried for 15 minutes at a temperature of 75° ± 1° C., followed by cooling at room temperature for 30 minutes. They shall then be examined for presence or absence of residual stains ("residue pattern" stains), the number and approximate size of which are recorded. Tests shall be run in triplicate.

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4.4.1.1.6 *Cleaning efficiency.* — The compound covered by this specification shall be equal or superior in cleaning efficiency to the standard comparison cleaner specified in 4.4.1.3, prepared and tested under the same conditions, in soil removal as measured by the weight of residual soil. Tests shall be run in triplicate for each type of soil. (See 6.3.)

4.4.1.2 Stability test.

4.4.1.2.1 *Preparation of solutions.* — In a 3-liter beaker, prepare 1600 ml. of a 7.5 percent (weight of compound in 100 ml. of solution) distilled water solution of the test compound. Boil the solution for 40 hours, replacing water lost by evaporation as necessary. Transfer the solution to a 2-liter beaker, bring to a boil, and keep the solution at a boil throughout the test, maintaining the solution level by addition of distilled water.

4.4.1.2.2 *Stability test procedure.* — Using the solutions prepared in 4.4.1.2.1, three test panels for each type of soil prepared and soiled in accordance with 4.4.1.1.1 and 4.4.1.1.2, shall be cleaned successively as specified in 4.4.1.1.4 (a total of six test panels). The residual solution on each panel shall be determined in accordance with 4.4.1.1.5. The test panels shall be cleaned in the following order: Mineral oil, then asphalt.

4.4.1.3 *Standard comparison cleaning compound.* — The composition of the standard comparison cleaning compound shall be as follows:

Component	*Percent by weight*
Sodium metasilicate, pentahydrate	34.5
Sodium phosphate, monobasic	12.0
Trisodium phosphate, dodecahydrate	33.5
Nonionic surface-active agent	5.2
Anionic surface-active agent	14.8

The components of the standard comparison alkali-type cleaning compound shall conform to the following requirements:

(1) Sodium metasilicate, pentahydrate—Federal Specification O–S–604.
(2) Trisodium phosphate dodecahydrate—Federal Specification O–T–671.
(3) Sodium phosphate monobasic—c.p. grade $NaH_2PO_4 \cdot H_2O$.
(4) Nonionic surface-active agent—"Triton X-100" manufactured by Rohm and Haas, "Igepal CA–630" manufactured by General Dyestuff Corporation, or "Atlas G–1690" manufactured by Atlas Powder Company, or equal.
(5) Anionic surface-active agent—"Nacconol NR" manufactured by National Aniline Division, Allied Chemical & Dye Corporation, or Santomerse #1 manufactured by Monsanto Chemical Company, or equal.

4.4.2 *Corrosion test.*

4.4.2.1 *Preparation of test panels.* — Test panels shall be cut 3 inches by ¾ inch in size from approximately ⅛ inch thick sheet aluminum conforming to Federal Specification QQ–A–561, ½ H temper. Sharp edges shall be smoothed with No. 1 emery cloth. Polish both faces with the same abrasive, stroking in one direction only.

4.4.2.2 *Cleaning of panels.*—Panels shall be cleaned with c. p. acetone, using a swab of absorbent cotton. They shall then be wiped with paper toweling, dipped in absolute ethyl alcohol, and again wiped with paper toweling.

4.4.2.3 *Corrosion test procedure.* — The clean test panel shall be weighed to nearest 0.0001 gram and immersed completely in 200 ml. of a 7.5 percent (weight of compound in 100 ml. of solution) distilled water solution of the compound, then boiled, utilizing a 500-ml. tall-form beaker. The solution shall be kept at a boil throughout the test, the solution level being maintained by additions of distilled water as required. After 60 minutes, the test panel shall be removed from the boiling solution, rinsed under flowing tap water (cold), rinsed in distilled water (20° — 26° C.), dipped in absolute ethyl alcohol, wiped dry with paper toweling, and reweighed. The presence of corrosion products shall be noted. Tests shall be run in duplicate.

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4.4.3 *pH value.*

4.4.3.1 *Apparatus.*—The test shall be made with a pH electrometer having a sensitivity and readability of at least 0.05 pH. A sealed type, alkali-resistant glass electrode shall be used with a calomel reference electrode. The meter shall be standardized against a pH 10 buffer solution immediately before making a test. The instrument to be used shall be the Beckman pH meter laboratory, model H, or equal and the electrode shall be the Beckman "Type E" high glass electrode or equal.

4.4.3.2 *Procedure.*—Prepare 100 ml. of a 7.5 percent (weight of compound in 100 ml. of solution) distilled water solution of the compound. Determine pH at 25° C. No correction for sodium ion concentration shall be made.

4.4.4 *Dust forming.*—The inside walls of a 250-ml. glass stoppered graduate shall be rendered completely free of any grease and moisture. A 25-gram sample of the cleaner shall then be placed on the bottom of the clean tube. The tube shall then be stoppered, inverted, and immediately returned to its original position. After any suspended dust has been allowed to settle for 5 seconds, the stopper of the tube shall be removed and a moistened piece of red litmus paper suspended in the tube without touching the walls so that the lower end of the litmus paper strip coincides with the 210 ml. mark at the upper end of the graduate. After 60 seconds immersion, the litmus paper shall be removed and examined for any color change.

4.4.5 *Surface tension.*—Dissolve 10 grams of the well-mixed compound in distilled water and dilute to volume in a 2-liter volumetric flask. Take a 10-ml. aliquot of this solution and dilute to volume in a 100-ml. volumetric flask. Determine the surface tension at 25° C., using a Du Nouy tensiometer or interfacial tensiometer with a 6-cm. circumference platinum ring. The instrument shall be calibrated with weights, and Harkins-Jordan Correction Factors shall be applied. The solution should stand 1 hour in test vessel before test is run.

4.4.6 *Penetration.* — Place 100 grams of the compound in a flat bottom, straight side, Pyrex glass crystallizing dish, 40 mm. high by 80 mm. diameter. Place sufficient lead shot in a 250-ml. low form beaker so that the combined weight of the beaker and shot equals 800 grams. Place the weighed 250-ml. beaker on top of the 100 grams of compound, then place the assembly in a dessicator containing a saturated solution of potassium sulphate (K_2SO_4). Place the dessicator in an oven maintained at 110° — 115° F. for 24 hours. Remove assembly from oven and dessicator; remove the weighed 250-ml. beaker from compound, and allow crystallizing dish containing compound to cool at room temperature for 2 hours. Determine penetration at three points on the surface, each at least 12 mm. from the side of the crystallizing dish, using the penetrometer and grease penetrometer cone prescribed for method 311, Federal Specification VV-L-791, with a 5-second hold, 250 grams total weight of the cone and attachments, and temperature of the compound at 75° — 77° F. Run test in duplicate and take average.

4.4.7 *Segregation.* — Samples taken from different portions of the container shall be analyzed for one constituent of the compound, such as silicates, carbonates, or total phosphates, by the appropriate method prescribed in Federal Specification P-S-536.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. — Unless otherwise specified, commercial packages are acceptable under this specification.

5.2 Packing.—Unless otherwise specified, the subject material shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance

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and safe delivery by common or other carrier, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Individual containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, each container shall be durably and legibly marked as follows:

Cleaning Compound, Alkali-Type
Fed. Spec. P–C–436a
Stock number.....
Quantity contained.....
Date of manufacture.....
Name of contractor...Batch or lot No....
Government order or contract No.....

5.3.2 *Shipment.* — In addition, all shipments shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129, or Federal Specification PPP–P–31, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** — Cleaning compound, alkali type, covered by this specification is intended for use in the hot soak cleaning of ferrous and nonferrous alloy parts. This specification is intended to supersede Ordnance Corps Tentative Specification AXS–1849, Compound, Cleaning, Alkali-Type.

6.2 **Ordering data.** — Procurement documents should specify the title, number, and date of this specification.

6.3 **Degree of cleanliness obtained with standard comparison cleaner.**—It has been found that test panels, soiled and cleaned with the standard comparison formula as specified herein, have shown the following results:

Asphalt soil . . . after 21 minutes, the test panel is completely cleaned.
Mineral oil soil . . . after 3 minutes, the test panel shows no waterbreak and no "residue-pattern" stains.

6.4 In the procurement of products requiring qualification, the right is reserved to reject bids on products that have not been subjected to the required tests and found satisfactory for inclusion on the Federal Qualified Products List. The attention of suppliers is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to have the products they propose to offer to the Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. Information pertaining to qualification of products covered by this specification may be obtained by communicating with: Commanding General, Aberdeen Proving Ground, Maryland, Attention: Paint and Chemical Laboratory.

6.5 **Treatment of asphalt prior to soiling.**—Bidders are cautioned against repeated heating of their entire stock of asphalt prior to spreading on the test panel. It is suggested that only enough asphalt be removed from the container on a spatula to soil one panel; soiling may be facilitated by slight heating (not over 50° C.) of both asphalt and panel.

6.6 **Granular product.** — Manufacture of the compound in accordance with best commercial practice will give a granular, free-flowing material. It has been found that these characteristics may be enhanced in some materials by holding the latter at a temperature of 120° F. for 24 hours followed by a short tumbling period. It is not implied that this treatment is necessary to produce a suitable compound.

6.7 **Penetration.**—The use of the equivalent amount of the monohydrate in place of the dodecahydrate trisodium phosphate tends to reduce caking tendencies in formulations containing sodium metasilicate pentahydrate. Granular characteristics are also improved. The comparison compound is to be formulated as specified in 4.4.1.3.

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6.8 Transportation description.

6.8.1 *Transportation description applicable to these items is:*

Cleaning Compound, not otherwise indexed by name, granular or powder.
Carload weight 36,000 pounds.
Truckload weight 36,000 pounds.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

7.1 The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

7.2 Army, Navy, and Air Force.

7.2.1 *Applicable specifications and standard.*

Military Specifications:

JAN-P-110—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment — Drums; Metal, 55-Gallon (for other than Petroleum Products).

MIL-C-124—Containers (Cans, Pails and Drums) Metal (For other than Subsistence Items).

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-129—Marking of Shipments.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

7.2.2 *Packaging (for domestic shipment and storage or overseas shipment.)*

7.2.2.1 The cleaning compound shall be furnished in 5-gallon drums and in 55-gallon steel drums, as specified in the procurement documents.

7.2.2.2 Five-gallon steel drums shall conform to type VI requirements of Military Specification MIL-C-124.

7.2.2.3 Unless otherwise specified in the procurement documents, 55-gallon closed-top steel drums shall conform to the requirements of Military Specification JAN-P-110.

7.2.3 *Packing (for domestic shipment and storage or overseas shipment.)*—Five-gallon steel drums and 55-gallon steel drums will require no further packing.

7.2.4 *Marking.*—In addition to any special marking required by the procurement documents, containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Army—O C Q T E
Navy—Or Sh S Y
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be

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